



Unhealthy tea bags?

Some tea bags leave behind high levels of microplastics in your tea but don't appear to be of risk - WHO. <https://digit.in/oct19-73>



Dew harvesting

New analysis suggests that clean water can be obtained from air in places that were until now deemed impossible. <https://digit.in/oct19-74>

Sony HT-X8500 2.1 Channel Soundbar

How good is a soundbar without a subwoofer?

Price
₹30,990



Soundbars have become popular over the past couple of years to compensate for the lacklustre quality of sound output from TVs. When it comes to connectivity options, the soundbar has an HDMI port for eARC/ARC and one HDMI pass-through port that supports 4K HDR pass through. And speaking of formats supported, the speaker does boast of support for DTS-X and Dolby Atmos which is nice. The touch buttons are quite sensitive and can be controlled with just a light tap. But they aren't so soft as to respond to accidental touches. The HT-X8500 has good sound reproduction and channel shift especially when you use it in a well-padded small room (12 feet x 15 feet). In a larger room, the surround effects are lost. The bass though present seems lacking especially when you are watching an action movie like Mission: Impossible. Needless to say that out of the box, the Virtual surround feature is gimmicky. At 70 per cent volume, the soundbar sounds really loud and you don't need to pump it higher. But you can and we went up to 90 per cent and the audio did not distort. The Sony HT-X8500 brings with it good performance especially considering the fact that it doesn't have a subwoofer. The bundled remote control is functional as well. The overall sound output is good for those looking for better sound when compared to TV speakers and don't want to delve into a complicated soundbar solution, or don't have space for it. On the downside, the virtual surround feature is quite gimmicky.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

INTERFACE: USB, Bluetooth 5.0 | EARC (HDMI): Yes | HDR (HDMI): Yes | LAYOUT: 2.1 Channels | POWER: 32 W | Dolby vision compatible.

CONTACT

SONY INDIA | PHONE: 1800-103-7799 | EMAIL: sonyindia.care@ap.sony.com | WEBSITE: www.sony.co.in

Cooler Master MM710 Gaming Mouse

Floats like a butterfly

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he gaming mice segment is clearly

divided among two camps at the moment, one that likes to have all the bells and whistles while the other being interested in mice that are lightweight and track well.

The Cooler Master MM710 falls in the latter category but it does away with all the bulk in order to be ultralight and at 53g, it's got that sorted pretty well. One look at the honeycomb mesh design is a very good indicator of that fact. And because it's open to the elements in this fashion, the PCBA sports a dust-proof coating which also adds a little splash resistance.

The MM710 comes with the PixArt PMW 3389 which is the top of the line from PixArt that can track at 400 IPS even at an acceleration of 50G, so those performing flick shots are going to love this one. We found the tracking to be quite exceptional at low acceleration as well as at high acceleration and there was no angle snapping. The combination of the paracord with the lightweight design and the PTFE feet makes the MM710 glide across the surface like butter.

On top of that, the lift off distance is just under 2.4 mm. For the left and right-click buttons, the MM710 uses Omron switches. The encoder is by ALPS and the scroll wheel button uses a Kailh switch.

Lastly, the thumb switches are by YT. For someone who doesn't require all the frills but just an excellent tracking mouse, the MM710 is one of the best ones you can get.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

MODEL: MM710 | MATERIAL: ABS Plastic | SENSOR: PixArt PMW 3389 | DPI LEVELS: 7 | DPI BUTTON: Y | POLLING RATE: 1000 Hz | BUTTONS: 6 | CABLE LENGTH: 1.8m | CABLE SLEEVING: Paracord | WEIGHT: 53g | WARRANTY: 2 years.

CONTACT

COOLER MASTER INDIA | PHONE: NA | EMAIL: Harshal_Tank@coolermaster.com.tw | WEBSITE: www.coolermaster.com

Price
₹3,999



FEATURES.....75
PERFORMANCE.....74
VALUE.....74
DESIGN.....73



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PERFORMANCE.....88
VALUE.....75
DESIGN.....86